Canned seafood (canned tuna, canned fish): HMTc Standard

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CITE AS

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CORRESPONDENCE

Corrections are logged publicly on the article page, each with its date, the affected value, and the source that resolved it.

KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for canned seafood, canned tuna and canned fish, stated as consumed. The metal ceilings are the general-fish government floor; the tin ceiling reflects the strictest canned-fishery maximum, because tin migrates from the can. A species-identified canned product (for example canned salmon) additionally meets its species subcategory where stricter.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default, 8:1 basis, read-across)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as consumed basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	200	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	50	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	1,000	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	100	government maximum level

Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	500	government maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	500	government maximum level
Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	2,000	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	100,000	government maximum level
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	100,000	human-grade read-across (China)
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	1,000	government maximum level
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	10	human-grade read-across (US-CA)

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	200	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	50	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	1,000	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	100	government maximum level
Mercury, total (tHg)	500	government maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	500	government maximum level
Nickel (Ni)	2,000	European Union — human-food analog
Tin (Sn)	100,000	government maximum level
Aluminium (Al)	100,000	China — human-food analog
Total chromium (Cr)	1,000	government maximum level
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	10	US-CA — human-food analog

4 | Cite this standard

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References

[1] China — human-food maximum levels
Binds Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds Ni. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] US-CA — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr-VI. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

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COMPETING INTERESTS

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DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/canned--seafood. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

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